Features, Labels, Targets

Learn to understand, design, build, test and explain AI systems responsibly.

Project: Responsible Plant Classifier

TEACHER GUIDE · 1 OF 9

Features, Labels, Targets

> Prepare Features, Labels, Targets: check the target, prerequisites, resources and adaptable teaching schedule.

Teach the learning cycle

Primary **target**: Separate **prediction input**s from observed **target**s

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Use “Run the investigation”, “Connect your project”, “Show what you know”, “Study a complete case” and “Try a new case independently”. Give extra time for the full task set. If this week has a coding lab, use its named section; section numbers can change when extra explanations are included.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building.

Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new **evidence**.

Retrieval answer guidance

The ML Lifecycle

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from The ML Lifecycle. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Distinguish **fitting** a rule from applying a fixed rule

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: The **input** is width x and the **label** is the observed category 0 or 1. Candidates are 2, 4 and 6.

Selection uses mistakes on the four **training** cards only; held out **label**s must not guide it.

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

A table has leaf length, edge type and verified species. A model predicts species using all three columns. Identify leakage and a legitimate **input** set.

Concept to explain

Features are the information available at **prediction time**; the **target** is the value the model should estimate; **label**s are observed **target** values in examples.

Term	Meaning
feature	input variable used for prediction
target	quantity or category to estimate
label	observed target value in a dataset
row	one example with fields

Prepare the class

Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.

Alternative compact allocation

> This compact option is not the full-week schedule. Use the main teaching cycle and allow extra sessions for the investigation, independent work and project.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

Teach **feature**s, **label**s and **prediction time** in two 45-minute sessions using fictional records. Students must define the decision moment before judging columns.

The key distinction is that **label**s may be known for historical **training** but must not be fed into **prediction**s for new cases.

This lesson prepares **input**s; it does not demonstrate a trained model or establish that loan **prediction** is useful. Use paper records or local Python, without accounts or personal borrowing data.

Readiness answer

They are reserved to evaluate the fixed choice. Using their **label**s to choose it makes them part of development.

Printed lesson and workbook

Two cards **label**led checkout and later return

Optional Python 3 editor; no external packages

Blank field meaning unit availability role table

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain **feature**s, **label**s, **target**s using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

Explain the mechanism

> Model Features, Labels, Targets using the supplied case, labelled mechanism and reasoning. Make the scope of each conclusion explicit.

Trace the information, fitted behavior, and evaluation proof separately.

Question to explain

QUESTION Mark **feature**s and **target**s in three datasets and reject information unavailable at real **prediction time**.

MODEL IDEA **Feature**s are the information available at **prediction time**; the **target** is the value the model should estimate; **label**s are observed **target** values in examples.

PROOF NEEDED Use an unseen case, visible calculation, error analysis, and a stated limitation.

How the mechanism works

UNDER THE HOOD Plant row: leaf_width=6 cm, color_score=0.72, health=spotted. **Feature**s are leaf_width and color_score because they exist before **prediction**.

Draw a fresh data → model → **prediction** → evaluation trace:

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible **evidence** cannot be audited.

Step 1

STEP 1 Plant row: leaf_width=6 cm, color_score=0.72, health=spotted.

Step 2

STEP 2 **Feature**s are leaf_width and color_score because they exist before **prediction**.

Step 3

STEP 3 **Target** is health; the stored value spotted is this row's **label**.

Step 4

STEP 4 A treatment-result field recorded later is not a valid **prediction**-time **feature**.

CHECK Verify the denominator, unit, split, class definition, and data version before interpreting a score.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the **evidence** independently:

Concrete teaching case

The teaching case

Rows contain leaf length, edge type and healthy/spotted **label**.

The teaching case

Identify **feature**s, **target** and **prediction**-time **input**s.

Exact explanation to model

Why the result follows

Length and edge type are candidate **feature**s; the **label** is the **target**. Do not supply the true **target** as an **input** to predicting it. Evaluate **feature** usefulness.

Explain the added worked example

Explain the added worked example · 1

Week 1 separated **training** examples from testing examples. This week asks a different question: could each **input** actually be known when a **prediction** is needed? A historical table may contain facts added after the event.

A model trained with those facts can appear successful even though the **input**s will be missing when it is used.

Explain the added worked example · 2

Use fictional library loans. At the instant a book is checked out, predict whether it will be returned more than 14 days later.

For completed historical loans, **label** 1 means days_to_return is greater than 14; **label** 0 means it is at most 14. Exactly 14 days is on time. Assume no changed due dates in this exercise.

All records and values are invented; do not collect classmates' borrowing histories.

Explain the added worked example · 3

queue_at_checkout is a saved count of waiting requests at that instant. It is not the queue when we later export the table. Candidate means available to consider, not proven useful or appropriate.

Exclude the arbitrary loan identifier from this exercise; keep it separately to track records.

Explain the added worked example · 4

The **feature** order is always pages first, queue count second. The first **output** is [120, 2]; the separate **label** is 1 because this historical loan took 18 days.

The new loan produces [80, 0] even though its return outcome does not yet exist. The same **feature** function serves past and new records.

It deliberately selects allowed fields rather than copying every column except returned_late.

This code prepares **input**s; it does not fit a model or predict lateness. It assumes the two **feature** fields contain valid nonnegative integer values and pages is positive. A missing required field raises KeyError.

A real pipeline needs explicit validation and a missing-data policy.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Feature contract	A specification of input meaning units order and timing
Target	The outcome a prediction aims to estimate
Prediction time	The moment when the prediction must be made
Target leakage	Predictor information that reveals the outcome but is unavailable at prediction time

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a **prediction**, then explain the deciding step.

These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Model the reasoning aloud · 5

For every proposed **input**, ask what it means, when it was recorded, and whether the same definition can be supplied at checkout. A field in the historical export is not automatically available at **prediction time**.

An **input** calculated from later information is also unavailable, even if its name does not mention the outcome.

> **A completed loan has pages 200, queue_at_checkout 3 and days_to_return 14. Write the feature list and label. Someone adds overdue_fee calculated after return. Can it become a feature for the checkout prediction? Explain.**

Thinking move	Teacher prompt
Plan	What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?
Do	Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.
Check	Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Features, Labels, Targets

Choose **feature**s that exist when a plant **prediction** must be made.

The facts we will use

> **Supplied facts**
>
> Predict next-week wilting at today's photo capture. Available fields: today_light,

today_soil_moisture, plant_id; next_week_wilt is the **target** recorded later.

Supplied facts

All **input**s and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read the picture one step at a time

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS AND WHY
1. Mark prediction time	The decision occurs today, before next week's outcome.
2. Select inputs	Today's light and soil readings are available features; plant_id identifies the plant.
3. Keep target separate	next_week_wilt supplies the training label, not an input available today.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Why the result follows

Read the picture in order. next_week_wilt supplies the **training label**, not an **input** available today. The arrows show which recorded **input** or intermediate result each decision uses.

Explain the deciding step aloud before checking the changed case; pointing to the final answer alone does not show how it follows.

What this example does not establish

Keep the stated limit

Eligible fields are not automatically useful or causal. Measure their predictive value with a

valid split.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change one thing

Change: A table adds tomorrow_soil_moisture as an **input**.

Predicted result

Prediction: Reject it for this **prediction**-time contract.

Why the result follows

Reason: Tomorrow's measurement is unavailable when today's **prediction** must be issued.

Ask while showing the picture

Ask while showing the picture · 6

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the **input**s and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its **evidence**. Then change the supplied condition and compare.

The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

TEACHER GUIDE · 3 OF 9

Demonstrate and guide practice

> Demonstrate Features, Labels, Targets, reduce support deliberately and check individual reasoning before discussing answers.

Choose the pacing route

Compact alternative: this two-session sequence covers selected core tasks. Use the three-session weekly plan for the full lesson, independent transfer, feedback and project work; allow extra time for extensions.

Board sequence

1. Put the facts on the board

Write the given facts: Rows contain leaf length, edge type and healthy/spotted **label**.

2. State the decision to explain

Write the question to explain: Identify **feature**s, **target** and **prediction**-time **input**s.

3. Reveal the worked reasoning

Reveal after **prediction**s: Length and edge type are candidate **feature**s; the **label** is the **target**. Do not supply the true **target** as an **input** to predicting it. Evaluate **feature** usefulness.

Hold back the independent task

Keep for an independent attempt: A row contains leaf_length_cm=8, leaf_width_cm=3 and species=fern. For predicting species, identify two **feature**s and the **target**.

Classroom dialogue

Ask the class

Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.

Language to model

Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks **evidence**; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

Model these guided questions

Guided: the ordered **input**s are [200, 3] and the observed **label** is 0 at exactly 14 days. The fee is calculated later and cannot be used for an earlier checkout **prediction**.

Exit example: use [pages, queue_at_checkout], in pages and requests, both recorded at checkout. An unknown future return outcome is not **evidence** of an on-time return and must not be silently **label**led 0.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage	Teacher action
Session 1 start to 7 minutes	Recall why held out labels must not choose the Week 1 threshold. Connect separate examples to the separate question of input availability.
7 to 18 minutes	State the checkout moment and label boundary. Place each field on the timeline. Explain why an arbitrary identifier can stay as metadata without becoming an input.

Stage	Teacher action
18 to 32 minutes	Trace the feature function on past and new records. Complete W1 and W2. Require the correct order and the 14 versus 15 day distinction.
32 to 45 minutes	Complete the guided 200-page loan and fee question. Ask which fields are unknown on a new checkout and why unknown does not mean zero.
Session 2 start to 8 minutes	Retrieve the contract: names, units, order and availability time. Ask students to explain one later field without using only the word leakage.
8 to 20 minutes	Use W3 to challenge a perfect test score. Trace how days_to_return reveals the answer even on separate test rows.
20 to 35 minutes	Collect W4 independently. Require inputs, target, exclusions, boundary answer and unknown-outcome explanation before giving hints.
35 to 45 minutes	Discuss W5 and the exit contract. Use the fresh retry after support where needed and record the support given.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion practice

Completion task: A completed loan has pages 96, queue_at_checkout 4 and days_to_return 14. Give the ordered **feature** list and **target**. Then state what changes if it took 15 days instead.

Reasoning to listen for

Teacher check: The **feature** list is [96, 4]. At 14 days the **target** is 0. At 15 days the **target** becomes 1; the checkout **feature** list remains [96, 4].

Start by identifying the given **input**s together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood.

For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for **Feature**s **label**s and **prediction time**. Proposed explanation: “Every stored column is a **feature**”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

> ### Expected repair
>
> Expected correction: A historical export combines information from different times. Require a meaning and timestamp before treating a column as an **input**.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class.

If it affects a few learners, give a short **target**ed group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Why can a historical table contain a field that is an invalid **input**? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or **evidence** that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

Historical exports combine measurements from different times. Availability at **prediction time**, not table presence, determines eligibility. Changed-case check: Reject it for this **prediction**-time contract.

Tomorrow’s measurement is unavailable when today’s **prediction** must be issued.

Changed-case reasoning: Reject it for this **prediction**-time contract. Tomorrow’s measurement is unavailable when today’s **prediction** must be issued.

Collect each learner’s explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between **input**, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery **evidence**.

Run the weekly evidence lab

> Run the Features, Labels, Targets investigation and use the first unsupported step to choose a teaching response.

Keep the test conditions fixed, record every result, and change only one planned factor.

1. Write the hypothesis and expected **evidence** before running.

2. **Feature**-or-**Target** Sort: annotate three tables, explain availability time, and find one disguised post-outcome field.

3. Run one normal, one boundary, one missing, and one shifted case.

4. Calculate the metric from raw counts or row-level errors.

5. Interpret what changed, what did not, and what remains unsafe or unknown.

Make the lab runnable

Use the concrete case as the shared normal case and the independent question as a second case. Each pair creates a boundary or missing-information case and predicts its result before testing.

Keep the expected result separate from an observed mistake.

Record	What to capture
Input or evidence	Exact data, instruction or claim
Expected result	Answer or safe fallback declared before the run
Observed result	Actual result, including errors
Explanation	Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome
Next test	One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose and reteach

MISCONCEPTION TO REPAIR Any column correlated with the answer is automatically a good **feature**.

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation.

Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

Every stored column is a **feature**: A historical export combines information from different times. Require a meaning and timestamp before treating a column as an **input**.

Removing the **label** column removes leakage: days_to_return and an outcome-based fee may still disclose the **target**. Audit how every field was created.

An unknown outcome is a negative **label**: Unknown means not established. In this exercise **label**s come from completed historical returns. Do not turn unavailable outcomes into on-time **label**s.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Missing or misread facts	Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.
Wrong procedure	Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Arithmetic or implementation error	Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.
Correct result without a reason	Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.
An unsupported wider claim	Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal.

Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

Assess and explain the answers

> Use the Features, Labels, Targets questions, teacher keys and criteria after the relevant attempts. Previously discussed cases are practice; protect the separately selected independent task.

Worked case answer

Teacher key · Worked case answer

Length and edge type are candidate **feature**s; the **label** is the **target**. Do not supply the true **target** as an **input** to predicting it. Evaluate **feature** usefulness.

Independent question

Independent question · withhold the key

A row contains leaf_length_cm=8, leaf_width_cm=3 and species=fern. For predicting species, identify two **feature**s and the **target**.

Expected independent answer

Teacher key · Expected independent answer

Leaf length and leaf width are **feature**s; species is the **target label**. Species must not also be used as an **input** for this **prediction** task.

What counts as evidence

Criterion	0 points	1 point	2 points
Result	Incorrect or absent	Partly correct	Correct with necessary conditions
Reasoning	No supporting trace	Some steps	Clear mechanism, calculation or source support
Limit	Overclaims certainty	Vague limitation	Relevant uncertainty or missing fact
Transfer	Copies without adapting	Adapts with prompts	Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold.

Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the **evidence** that challenges this claim: “The **target** can be included as an **input** because it improves apparent accuracy.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

Teacher key · Original transfer answer

Verified species is the **target** and must not be supplied as a **prediction feature**. Use length and edge type if available at **prediction time**, then evaluate their usefulness.

Numeric encoding of the **target** does not make it a legitimate **input**.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Assign the roles

Workbook question · W1

For the worked loan table, identify the two candidate **feature**s, the **target label** and the tracking field. Explain why days_to_return is not a predictor.

Teacher reasoning · W1

Candidate **feature**s are pages and queue_at_checkout.

The **target** is returned_late and the tracking field is loan_id. days_to_return is known only after return and directly defines the **target**, so it must not enter checkout **prediction**s.

W2 Trace the feature contract

Workbook question · W2

A completed loan has pages 96, queue_at_checkout 4 and days_to_return 14. Give the

ordered **feature** list and **target**. Then state what changes if it took 15 days instead.

Teacher reasoning · W2

The **feature** list is [96, 4]. At 14 days the **target** is 0. At 15 days the **target** becomes 1; the checkout **feature** list remains [96, 4].

W3 Repair a misleading score

Workbook question · W3

A model has every test **prediction** correct after using pages and days_to_return. A learner says a separate test set makes this valid. Explain the flaw and repair the **input**s.

Teacher reasoning · W3

The test rows contain future information that reveals the **label**. Separate rows do not make days_to_return available at checkout.

Remove later outcome fields, use the checkout **feature contract**, and rerun development and evaluation with honest records.

W4 Audit a new task independently

Workbook question · W4

A fictional robot predicts at dispatch whether a parcel trip will take more than 10 minutes.

Fields are route_steps and queue_at_dispatch captured at dispatch, trip_id for tracking, arrival_minutes measured after arrival, and slow = 1 when arrival_minutes > 10. Specify **input**s, order, **target** and exclusions.

For a past trip with steps 30, queue 2, arrival 10, give **feature**s and **label**. For a new trip with steps 24 and queue 0, give **feature**s and explain whether slow is known.

Teacher reasoning · W4

Use [route_steps, queue_at_dispatch] in that order, measured in steps and queued trips at dispatch. slow is the **target**. Keep trip_id as tracking metadata; exclude arrival_minutes and slow from **input**s.

Past **feature**s are [30, 2] with **label** 0 because 10 is not greater than 10. New **feature**s are [24, 0]; slow is unknown until the outcome can be established.

W5 Handle an unavailable input

Workbook question · W5

For the robot task, a dataset stores queue_now at export time but has no saved queue_at_dispatch. Can you rename that field to make it usable? State a defensible next step.

Teacher reasoning · W5

Renaming does not restore the missing dispatch-time value. Recover a reliable timestamped dispatch snapshot if available, or remove the **feature** and reevaluate the revised design.

Do not invent a zero queue or copy the later count.

Assess independent transfer

Independent question · withhold the key

Selected case: A fictional robot predicts at dispatch whether a parcel trip will take more than 10 minutes.

Fields are route_steps and queue_at_dispatch captured at dispatch, trip_id for tracking, arrival_minutes measured after arrival, and slow = 1 when arrival_minutes > 10. Specify **input**s, order, **target** and exclusions.

For a past trip with steps 30, queue 2, arrival 10, give **feature**s and **label**. For a new trip with steps 24 and queue 0, give **feature**s and explain whether slow is known.

Selected case answer

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Use [route_steps, queue_at_dispatch] in that order, measured in steps and queued trips at dispatch. slow is the **target**. Keep trip_id as tracking metadata; exclude arrival_minutes and slow from **input**s.

Past **feature**s are [30, 2] with **label** 0 because 10 is not greater than 10. New **feature**s are [24, 0]; slow is unknown until the outcome can be established.

Dimension	Evidence required
Explanation	Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.
Trace and result	Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.
Limits	States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace.

Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its **evidence** and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case.

Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

Connect and extend learning

> Connect Features, Labels, Targets to Responsible Plant Classifier, adapt support and plan a later changed-case check.

Responsible Plant Classifier

Define the Plant Classifier **target** and a first **feature** list; record units, allowed values, collection method, and availability time.

Keep the decision, **input**, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project **evidence** record. Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Support and stretch

Use a tiny **label**led dataset, explicit units and a named positive class. Stretch: require a baseline, held-out evaluation and subgroup or shifted-condition analysis with denominators.

Exit reflection

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more **evidence** or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Bridge to the next week

Next: Week 3: Classification or Regression?. Retrieve today's **evidence** and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Support and fresh reassessment

Place field cards before or after the **prediction**-time line. Supply an empty contract table, not completed answers. Extension: a queue measurement is recorded before checkout but overwritten at export.

Explain why its current value is not necessarily the original snapshot, and propose retaining timestamped history.

Require W4 **feature**s [30, 2], **target** 0, new **feature**s [24, 0], unknown new **target**, and the timing reason for exclusions. A column list without timing justification is insufficient.

Fresh retry: at print-job submission, predict whether completion takes more than 5 minutes. **Input**s are page_count then queue_at_submit. A completed job has 12 pages, queue 1, completion_minutes 6: **input**s [12, 1], **label** 1.

A new job has 8 pages, queue 0: **input**s [8, 0], **label** unknown. Exclude completion_minutes and the **label** from **input**s; keep job_id as metadata. Exactly 5 minutes would have **label** 0.

Week 3 distinguishes classification **target**s from regression **target**s. Carry forward the explicit **target** definition and **prediction time**.

Teacher reference: https://scikit-learn.org/stable/common_pitfalls.html#data-leakage (reviewed 2026-09-26).

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-4/3, ai-4/5, ai-4/8. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used.

For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record	Teacher evidence
Learner code and date	
Concept and case used; prior exposure	
Explanation / trace / limits	
Support and first repair	
Changed case and delayed outcome	
Next teaching action	

Use the **evidence** to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Responsible Plant Classifier, save the **input**, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check.

Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.

Prepare, teach and assess

> Use this preparation summary alongside the detailed Features, Labels, Targets lesson; it is a checklist rather than a replacement for the full sequence.

Teaching target

Teaching **target**: Separate **prediction input**s from observed **target**s

Prepare the **label**led worked-case picture, the matching workbook, fictional **input** cards and a place for individual responses. Check a local Python 3 environment before class; have a paper-trace version ready.

Session · Plan · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Use “Run the investigation”, “Connect your project”, “Show what you know”, “Study a complete case” and “Try a new case independently”. Give extra time for the full task set. If this week has a coding lab, use its named section; section numbers can change when extra explanations are included.

Before class, solve the supported practice: A completed loan has pages 96, queue_at_checkout 4 and days_to_return 14. Give the ordered **feature** list and **target**. Then state what changes if it took 15 days instead.

Supported practice answer

Reasoned practice answer: The **feature** list is [96, 4]. At 14 days the **target** is 0. At 15 days the **target** becomes 1; the checkout **feature** list remains [96, 4].

Check every learner before discussion: Use the worked case for **Feature**s **label**s and **prediction time**. Proposed explanation: “Every stored column is a **feature**”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Repair the misconception

Misconception repair: A historical export combines information from different times. Require a meaning and timestamp before treating a column as an **input**.

Support without giving away the answer

Support: read the exact case aloud, enlarge the **label**led picture, supply **input** cards and model only the first deciding step. Accept a spoken explanation or drawing; retain the reasoning goal.

Extend the reasoning

Extension: A table adds tomorrow_soil_moisture as an **input**. Require a **prediction** and a reason before comparing. Expected result: Reject it for this **prediction**-time contract.

Reason: Tomorrow's measurement is unavailable when today's **prediction** must be issued.

Protect the independent attempt

Independent assessment: withhold the reserved answer until the learner has attempted the new case. Record support separately from correctness.

Criterion	Not yet	With support	Independent
Explanation	Names an answer without a deciding fact	Uses a hint to link fact and decision	Explains the deciding fact in own words
Trace or test	Cannot connect input and result	Completes steps with prompts	Traces or tests a changed case accurately
Limits and revision	Claims more than evidence supports	Names a limit after a prompt	States a defensible limit and useful next test

Project checkpoint

Project checkpoint: Frame the need. Name the user, the problem, allowed **input**s and a safe simple starting method.

Use the weekly teacher answer for topic-specific reasoning. A saved progress tick is an activity record; judge mastery from the learner's explanation and **evidence**.

TEACHER GUIDE · 8 OF 9

Use feedback, labs and repair paths

> Use feedback, earlier review and portfolios purposefully. Apply the coding routine only when this lesson has an executable lab.

Use the two formative questions as supported practice, not as independent mastery scores. Discuss the deciding **evidence** rather than accepting a guessed selection.

The feedback comes from the reviewed public worked case. Do not reveal the separately reserved independent teacher answer until the learner has attempted that case.

Ask students to predict before running code. Preserve errors and actual **output**s; collect a changed test and an explanation. The branch-boundary and indexing lessons deliberately include failure cases.

Use the earlier worked-explanation links to address a specific missing building block, then return to the current question. Adapt this suggestion after observing the learner; it is not an automatic diagnosis.

Collect the completed-work portfolio as **evidence**. Record support separately from correctness, and assess explanation, trace/test and limitations. Progress ticks and quiz selections alone do not establish mastery.

TEACHER GUIDE · 9 OF 9

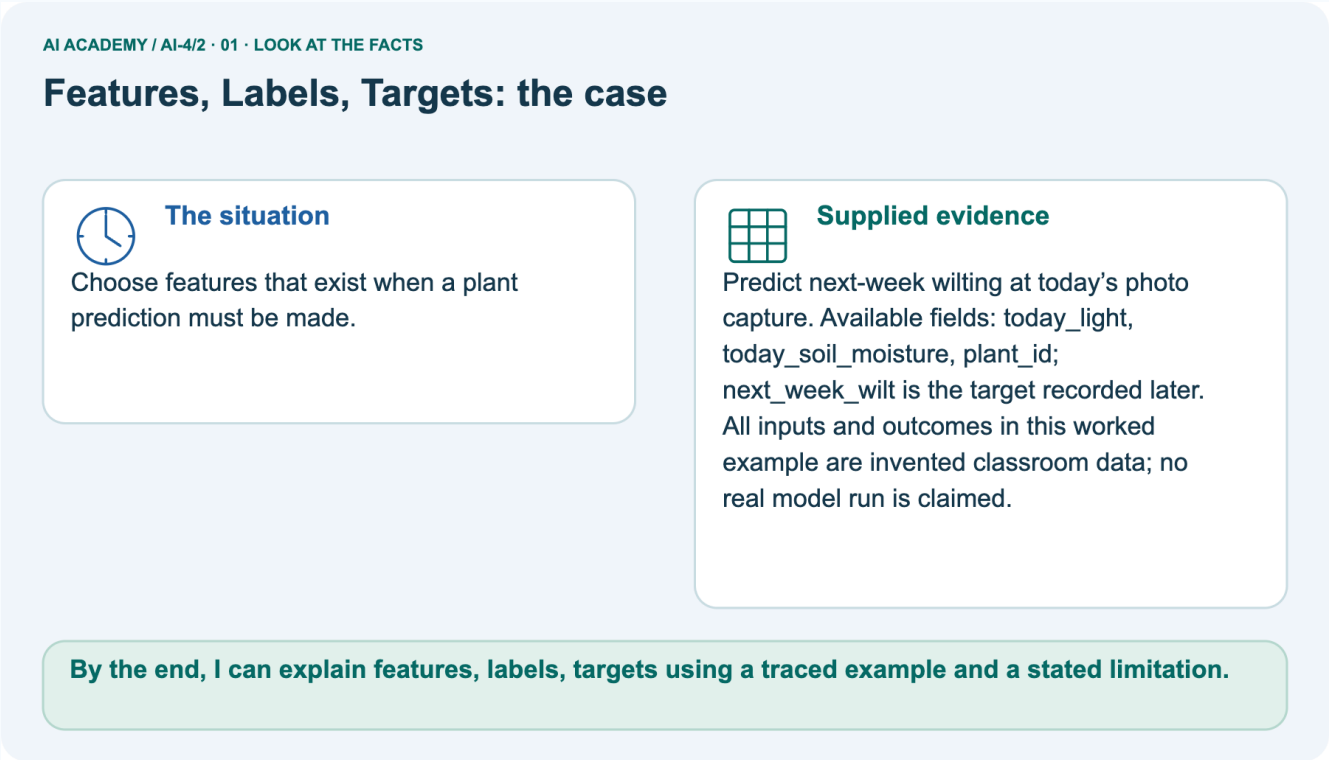
Visual concept journey

> Show one Features, Labels, Targets graphic at a time, request a prediction and discuss its

> trace before the independent assessment.

Use one picture at a time. Hide a worked result before asking for a **prediction**, then reveal it for feedback. These are supported teaching cases; retain the separate independent assessment for a fresh first attempt.

01. Features, Labels, Targets: the case



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Choose **feature**s that exist when a plant **prediction** must be made. Supplied facts: Predict next-week wilting at today's photo capture.

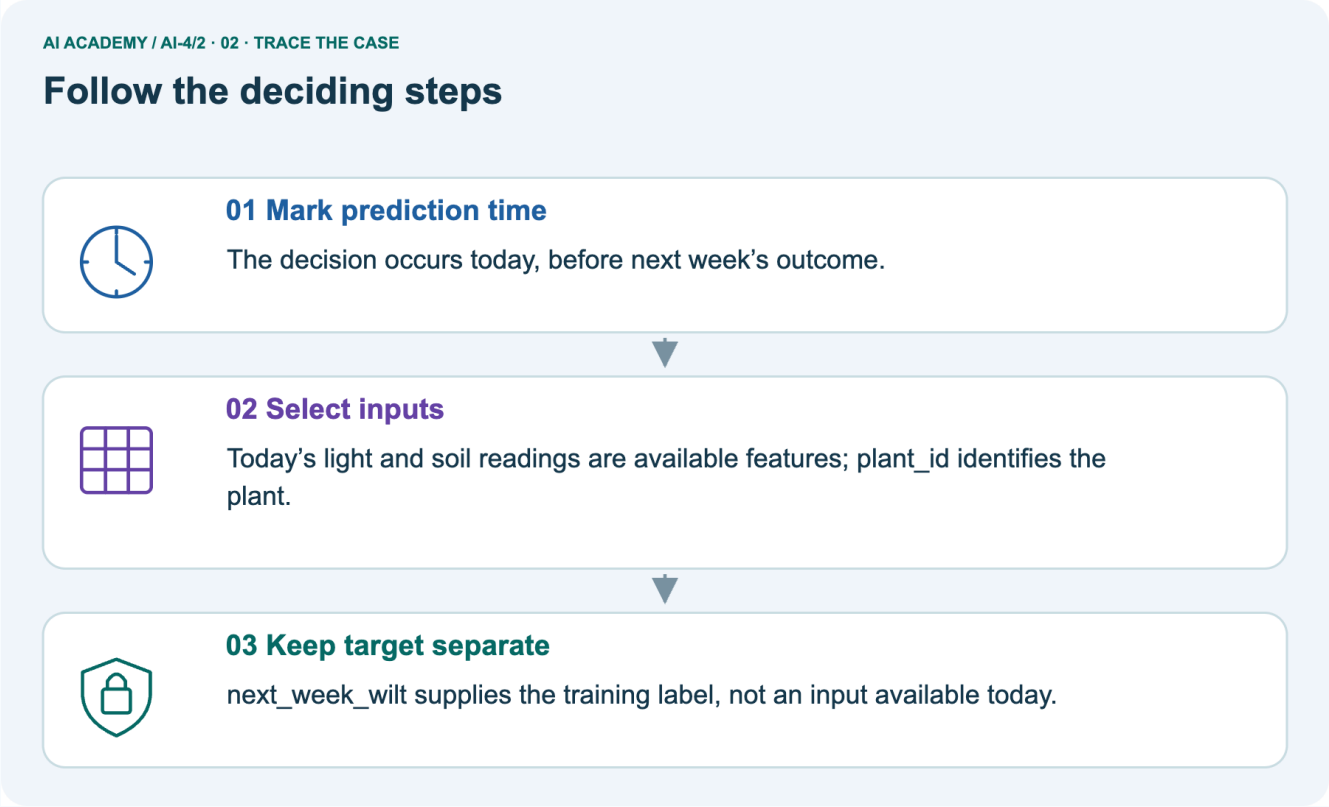
Available fields: today_light, today_soil_moisture, plant_id; next_week_wilt is the **target** recorded later. All **input**s and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

> Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters. Ask learners to describe one **label** or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

02. Follow the deciding steps



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

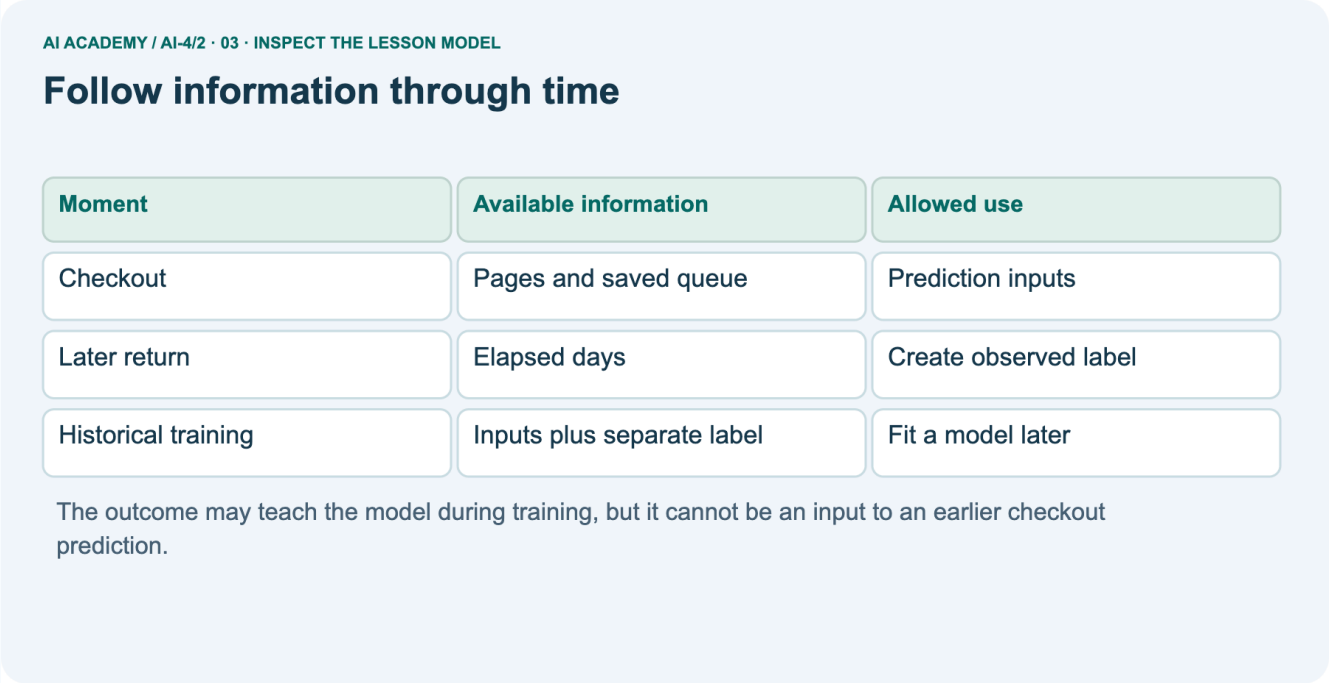
Mark **prediction time**: The decision occurs today, before next week's outcome. → Select **input**s: Today's light and soil readings are available **feature**s; plant_id identifies the plant. → Keep **target** separate: next_week_wilt supplies the **training label**, not an **input** available today.

Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses. Ask learners to describe one **label** or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

03. Follow information through time



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

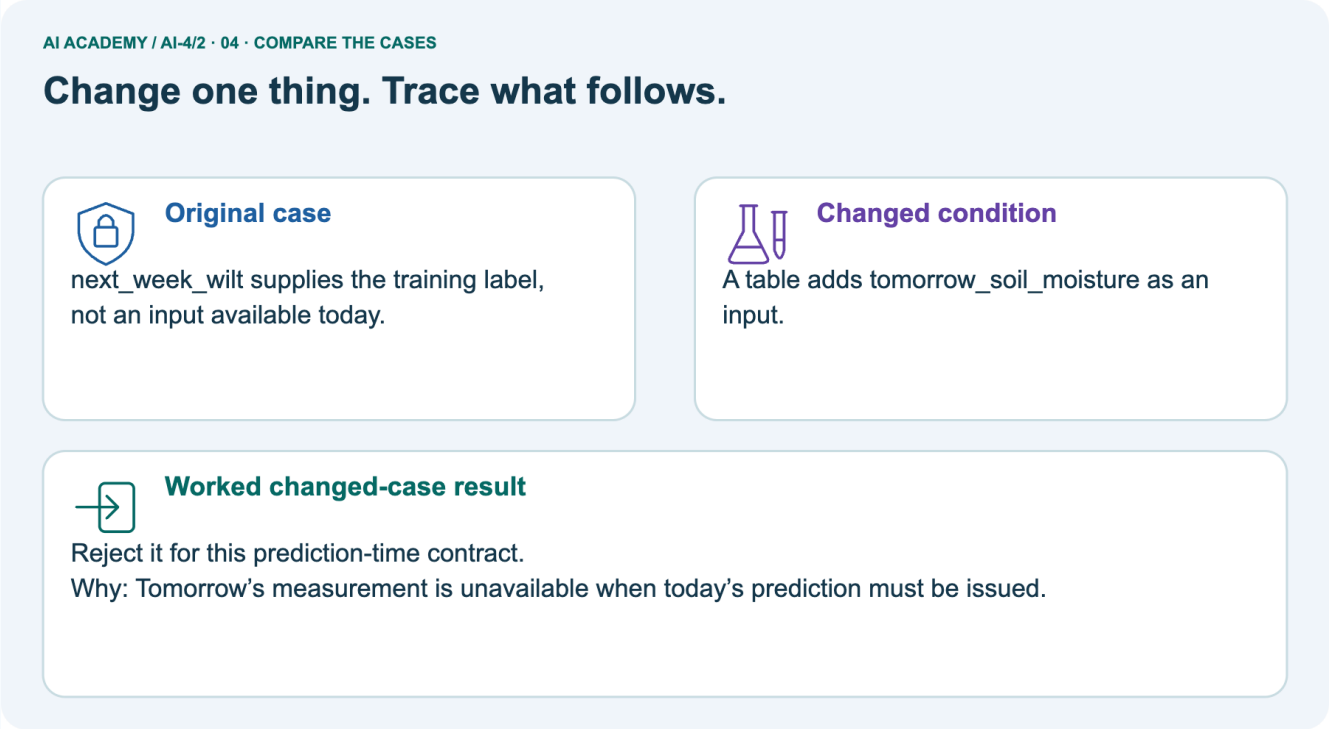
Follow information through time. Checkout | Pages and saved queue | **Prediction input**s. Later return | Elapsed days | Create observed **label**. Historical **training** | **Input**s plus separate **label** | Fit a model later

Read the **label**s and values. Explain the relationship the model shows.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Read the **label**s and values. Explain the relationship the model shows. Ask learners to describe one **label** or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

04. Change one thing. Trace what follows.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Original case: next_week_wilt supplies the **training label**, not an **input** available today. Changed condition: A table adds tomorrow_soil_moisture as an **input**. Expected result: Reject it for this **prediction**-time contract.

Reason: Tomorrow's measurement is unavailable when today's **prediction** must be issued.

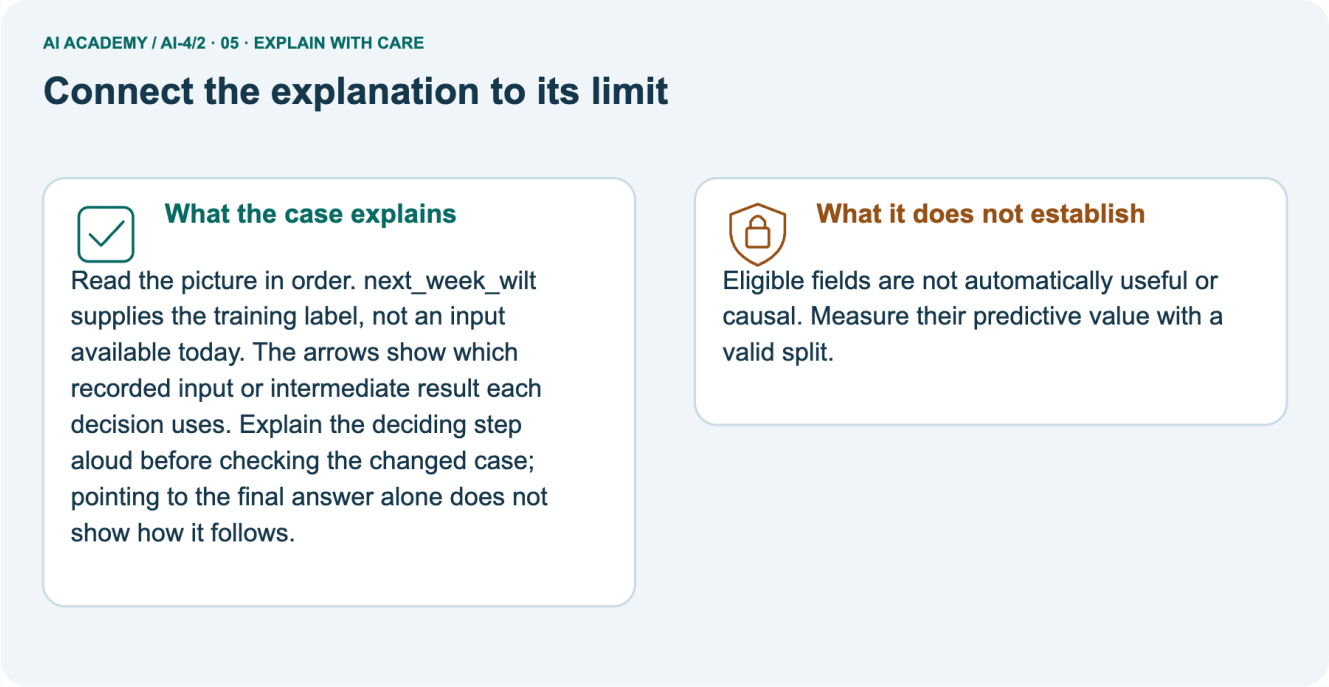
Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude. Ask learners to describe one **label** or arrow in ordinary words.

Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see. Changed-case reasoning: Tomorrow's measurement is unavailable when today's **prediction** must be issued.

05. Connect the explanation to its limit



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read the picture in order. next_week_wilt supplies the **training label**, not an **input** available today. The arrows show which recorded **input** or intermediate result each decision uses.

Explain the deciding step aloud before checking the changed case; pointing to the final answer alone does not show how it follows. Limit: Eligible fields are not automatically useful or causal.

Measure their predictive value with a valid split.

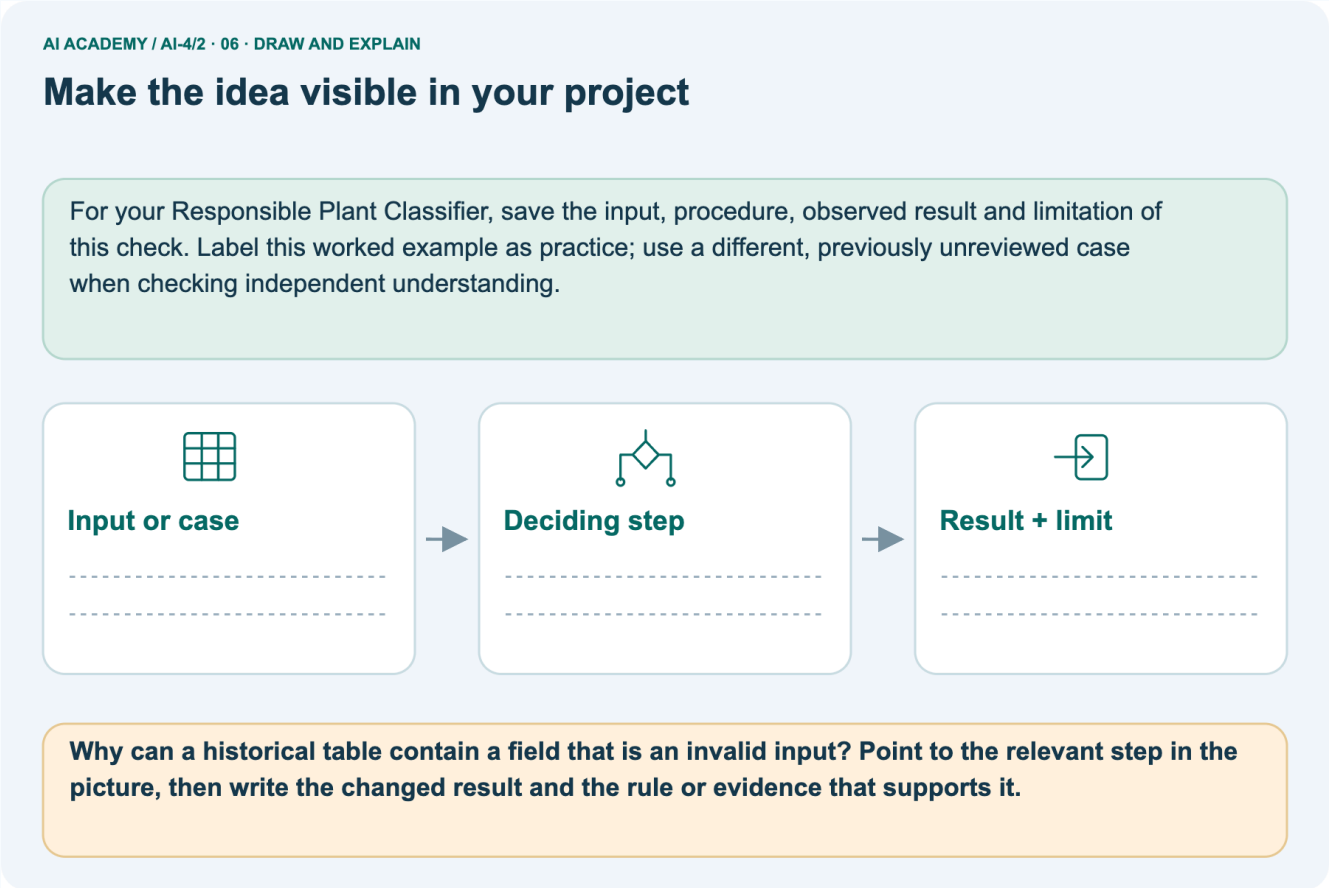
Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim. Ask learners to describe one **label** or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Keep the stated scope: Eligible fields are not automatically useful or causal. Measure their predictive value with a valid split.

06. Make the idea visible in your project



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

For your Responsible Plant Classifier, save the **input**, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check.

Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding. Draw your **input**, deciding step, result and limit.

Supported question: Why can a historical table contain a field that is an invalid **input**? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or **evidence** that supports it.

Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**. Ask learners to describe one **label** or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Supported practice key: Historical exports combine measurements from different times. Availability at **prediction time**, not table presence, determines eligibility.

Changed-case check: Reject it for this **prediction**-time contract. Tomorrow's measurement is unavailable when today's **prediction** must be issued.

Save or print your responses for your portfolio. Progress and drafts on the hosted website stay in the current browser. Use only fictional or teacher-approved data.